

Dan Ogrodnik

Curriculum Vitae — rewrite in progress (2026)

Session & Live Musician · Music Director · Session & Live Engineer

Los Angeles / Crestline, CA

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Summary

Classically trained percussionist (CalArts MFA, Multi-Focus Percussion; Hartt BM) with extensive session and live work across classical, contemporary, and world traditions. Music direction, tracking / mixing, and live sound (FOH / monitors) when needed. Ghana residency (Dagara / Dagbe).

For 5+ years, live accompanist at the USC Gloria Kaufman School of Dance. Headline credits also include Capitol Records sessions, Hands On'Semble with Rhein Percussion, the West Coast premiere of John Luther Adams's *Inuksuit*, and Bella Strings for King Salman of Saudi Arabia.

This document consolidates an older long-form CV into a hire-facing rewrite. Gaps (especially post-2017 detail and engineer credits) remain to improve.

Services

Session & live musician — World and classical percussion for studio, stage, festival, theater pit, and dance-class accompaniment.

Music direction — Charts, rehearsals, cues, show pacing.

Session & live engineering — Tracking and mixing (Pro Tools, Reaper, Ableton Live, Logic Pro; MaxMSP). Live sound FOH / monitors.

Teaching & clinics — Private study, classroom, guest masterclasses (incl. CalArts Percussion Forum; Evergreen Community School).

Selected credits

- CalArts MFA (Multi-Focus Percussion); Hartt BM; Ghana residency (Dagara / Dagbe), 2008
 - **USC Gloria Kaufman School of Dance** — live accompanist, 5+ years (Contemporary, Afro-Cuban, Partnering, Modern, Hip-Hop, Jazz, Commercial Dance, Dunham Technique, improvisation, guest clinicians). Instructors include Desmond Richardson, Dwight Rhoden, Patrick Corbin, Victor Quijada; Complexions Contemporary Ballet Summer Intensive. Original music for Kaufman choreography.
 - John Luther Adams: *Inuksuit* — West Coast premiere, Ojai Music Festival (curated by Steven Schick)
 - Hands On'Semble with Rhein Percussion — The Blue Whale
 - Bella Strings — The Beverly Hilton, performance for King Salman of Saudi Arabia
 - Capitol Records sessions (incl. Cross Pulses; Abuelo; Celia Cruz *Luna Sobre Matanzas* selected for mastering)
 - Ensembles / projects: Izela (*I*), ZAUB, Sin Color, Rhein Percussion, The Milky Way, Rio de Choro
 - Selected artists: Kan Wakan, Sofi Mkheyan, Saba Alizadeh, Vinny Golia, Sulley Imoro
 - Theater / musical pits including *The Boy from Oz*, *Spring Awakening*
 - Guest solo masterclasses; Rhein Percussion clinics at CalArts
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Education

MFA, Multi-Focus Percussion — California Institute of the Arts, 2013

Teachers include Swapan Chaudhuri, Randy Gloss, Houman Pourmehdi, David Johnson, Andrew Grueschow, Sulley Imoro, Pete Lockett, Aaron Serfaty, and others.

BM, Percussion Performance — The Hartt School, University of Hartford, 2009

Teachers include Ben Toth, Shane Shanahan, Rogerio Boccato, Joseph Galeota, John Amira, Robert Black, Nebojša Jovan Živković, and others.

Residence, Ghana — Dagara Music Center (Bernard Woma); Dagbe Music Center (Emmanuel / Ruben / Nani Agbeli), 2008.

Selected recordings

- Izela — *I* (2017)
 - ZAUB — *Excuse Mui* (2016); additional releases
 - Sin Color — *Pregunto* (2016)
 - Capitol-related: Cross Pulses (Rhein Percussion); Abuelo (Saba Alizadeh); Celia Cruz *Luna Sobre Matanzas*
 - Paul Matthis — *Asterozoa*; Jonah Christian — *Manj Score*; *Suspect*; Alex Emami; *Rio de Choro EP*; others
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Tools

Production: Pro Tools · Reaper · Ableton Live · Logic Pro · MaxMSP

Studying (not production credits): Wwise · FMOD · Unity audio · Unreal audio / MetaSounds

Memberships

Percussive Arts Society (2005–present)

Rewrite in progress — condensed from recovered CV. Full chronology available on request. Update planned for post-2017 credits and engineer detail.